Buzzy Bees Physiotherapy

Buzzy Bees Physiotherapy Consent Policy

1. Purpose

This policy outlines how our clinic obtains informed consent from patients (adults and children) prior to assessment and treatment. It ensures that all patients understand the nature, purpose, benefits and risks of physiotherapy interventions and agree to receive care voluntarily.

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2. Adult Consent

Definition: Adult patients are individuals aged 18 years or older who are capable of making their own healthcare decisions.

Policy:

1. **Information Provision** – Before any treatment, the physiotherapist will explain:
    - The assessment and treatment plan.
    - Expected benefits and potential risks.
    - Alternative options, including no treatment.
2. **Voluntary Consent** – Consent must be freely given without pressure.
3. **Documentation** – Written consent will be obtained via the patient intake form and recorded in the patient's notes.
4. **Ongoing Consent** – Consent is not a one-time event; patients can withdraw or modify consent at any point during treatment.
5. **Capacity** – If a patient lacks capacity to consent, treatment may only proceed with a legally authorised representative.

Statement for Patients:
"I have received information about my assessment and treatment, understand the risks and benefits and agree to receive physiotherapy care."

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3. Child Consent

Definition: Children are individuals under 18 years of age. Parental/guardian consent is required.

Policy:

1. **Parental/Guardian Consent** – A parent or legal guardian must provide consent before the child is assessed or treated.
2. **Child Assent** – Where possible, the child's understanding and willingness to participate will be sought in age-appropriate language.

3. **Information Provision** – The physiotherapist will explain to the parent/guardian and the child:
    - The assessment and treatment plan.
    - Expected benefits and potential risks.
    - Alternatives, including the option not to treat.
4. **Documentation** – Consent will be recorded on a child consent form and included in the patient record.
5. **Ongoing Consent** – Parents/guardians and children can withdraw consent at any time.

Statement for Parents/Guardians:
"I am the parent/legal guardian of [child's name]. I have received information about the proposed assessment and treatment, understand the potential risks and benefits, and give consent for my child to receive physiotherapy care."

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4. Review and Updates

- This policy is reviewed annually or when there are changes in legislation, clinical guidelines, or clinic procedures.
- All staff are trained to follow this consent policy and to answer questions from patients or guardians.

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5. Responsibilities

- **Physiotherapists:** Ensure informed consent is obtained and documented.
- **Reception/Admin Staff:** Provide consent forms and explain procedures to patients/guardians.
- **Clinic Owner/Manager:** Monitor adherence to this policy and provide staff training.